

Official Statement of Lack of Funding for Publication Fees

Date: May 12, 2026

To: PLOS ONE Publication Fee Assistance Team

Dear PLOS ONE Financial Department,

I am writing this formal declaration to confirm that I am an undergraduate student currently enrolled in the Bachelor's degree program at Western Caspian University in Baku, Azerbaijan.

The research submitted in my manuscript (Transcriptomic Characterization of Triple-Negative Breast Cancer Identifies Distinct Immune Infiltration Patterns and PI3K-Akt Hyperactivation) was conducted entirely independently, utilizing publicly available, open-source bioinformatics datasets.

I hereby formally declare that:

1. I have received zero (\$0) financial support, grants, or external funding for this research project.
2. Western Caspian University does not provide institutional budgets or departmental funding to cover Article Processing Charges (APCs) for undergraduate researchers.
3. As a student in a lower-middle-income country (Azerbaijan), I do not have personal financial resources to cover the estimated publication fee of \$940 USD.

I have exhausted all potential institutional and national funding avenues, none of which are available for this work. Therefore, I respectfully request a full fee waiver under the PLOS Global Participation Initiative so that this scientific contribution can be published.

I certify that all statements made in this document are true and accurate.

Sincerely,

Suleiman Hajizadeh

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